

Ladder Consulting Platform

Complete Workflow & Feature Reference

- Full-Stack SaaS
- Node.js + React 19 + MySQL
- v2026-06-16
- 5 User Roles · 8 Modules

1. Platform Overview — Roles & Portals



Admin
Full platform control, approvals, settings, analytics



HR Staff / Executive
Leads, tasks, sourcing, invoices, approvals



Company
Jobs, shortlists, interviews, offers, payments



Candidate
Profile, resume, job search, applications, interviews



Trainer
Manage courses, modules, benchmarks

PORTAL ROUTES

Role	Home Route	Key Sections	Can Also Access
admin	/admin	Dashboard · Companies · Staff · Analytics · Payments · Training Manager · Settings · Audit Log	/hr/* and /outreach/*
hr_staff	/hr	Dashboard · Employees · Tasks · Reports · Offer Requests · Interview Requests · Invoices · Sourcing	/outreach/*
company	/company	Dashboard · Jobs · Talent Pool · Shortlist · Interviews · Offers · Payments · Training · Requests · Profile	—
candidate	/candidate	Dashboard · Profile · Browse Jobs · Applications · Interviews · Documents	—
trainer	/admin/training	Training Manager (Catalogue · Courses · Benchmarks · Assignments · Progress)	—

AUTHENTICATION FLOW



Company accounts also require admin approval before accessing the portal. Session restored on reload via GET /auth/me. Password reset via email link. Maintenance mode blocks all non-admin logins.

2. Core Recruitment Lifecycle

The primary revenue workflow — from job posting to placement fee collection. Two mandatory executive approval gates protect Ladder's placement revenue.



APPLICATION STATUS PIPELINE



| also: rejected / withdrawn

Once any application reaches 'hired', the candidate is locked platform-wide — no further applications, shortlisting, sourcing, or offer-sending allowed for that candidate.

3. Cold Outreach Module

EMAIL CAMPAIGN FLOW

1. Upload Excel/CSV Contact List → background import → outreach_contacts

2. Create Email Campaign (select list, write template with merge tags)

3. Send Campaign (batches of 20 with 1s delay, can pause mid-send)

4. IMAP Poller (every 2 min) matches replies via tagged Reply-To address

5. Executive receives reply in Replies inbox → reply / convert to lead / ignore

6. Convert to Lead → Leads Pipeline with stage progression

Merge tags: {{first_name}} {{full_name}} {{company_name}} {{designation}} {{city}}
{{executive_name}}

WHATSAPP + COLD CALLS

WhatsApp Campaign

- Create template (header/body/footer + variables) → Meta approval
- Create campaign with variable mapping → send via WhatsApp Cloud API
- Incoming messages arrive via Meta webhook → same Replies inbox

Cold Calls

- Dial contact, log outcome: no_answer / voicemail / callback_scheduled / interested / converted
- Callback → notification to executive at scheduled time
- Convert to lead directly from call log

LEAD PIPELINE STAGES



4. Payment & Invoicing System

📄 Placement Fee

- Triggered on exec approval of offer-letter request
- invoice_type = placement_fee in invoices table
- Amount = placement_fee_multiplier × offered CTC
- Partial payments supported (amount_paid tracked)
- PFI status mirrored via syncPlacementFeeStatus()

🎓 Training Fee

- Triggered on admin approval of training request
- invoice_type = training_fee in invoices table
- Amount = price_per_user × num_users
- Same Cashfree payment flow on /company/payments
- Company emailed invoice number on approval

📄 HR Executive Invoices

- Executive raises manual invoices for their companies
- Types: placement_fee / partial_payment / other_fee / training_fee
- Admin sees all via Payments page (Service Invoices tab)
- Mark paid / partially paid / waived controls

CASHFREE PAYMENT FLOW



Webhook: POST /api/payments/webhook/cashfree — HMAC signature verified, PAYMENT_SUCCESS processed idempotently. Redirect: /company/payments/:invoiceId/callback

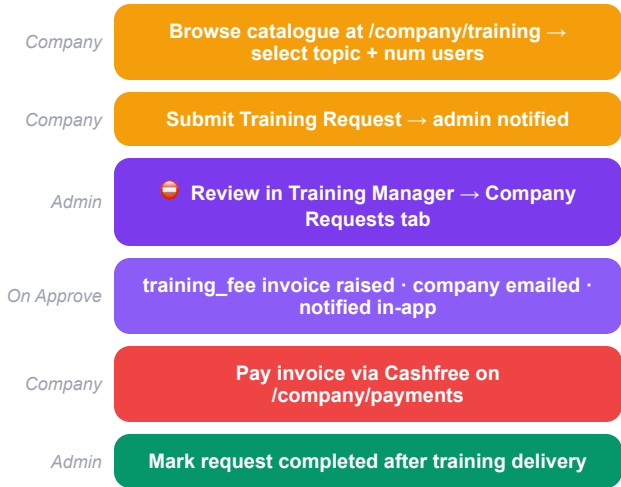
5. Training Services Module (Company Subscription)

7 TRAINING TOPICS (FIXED CATALOGUE)

Topic	Category	Duration	Price / User
Onboarding Training	Onboarding	5 days	₹5,000
Cultures & Values	Culture	2 days	₹3,000
Office Etiquette	Professionalism	1 day	₹2,000
Presentation Skills	Communication	3 days	₹4,000
Conflict Management	Leadership	2 days	₹4,000
Sales Basics	Sales	3 days	₹5,000
Sales Advanced	Sales	5 days	₹7,000

Admin can add / edit / deactivate topics via Training Manager → Training Catalogue.

TRAINING REQUEST WORKFLOW



6. Admin Control Panel

🔑 Core Admin Actions

- Approve / reject / suspend companies
- Assign HR executive to company
- Create / deactivate HR staff accounts
- Suspend / reactivate candidates
- Review all company requests (interview / offer / profile)
- Recruitment pipeline oversight

📊 Platform Analytics

- KPIs: Candidates · Offers · Accept Rate · Avg Match Score
- Financial: Invoiced / Collected / Outstanding / Overdue
- Executive Performance table (companies, leads, sourced, fees)
- Monthly registration charts · Recruitment funnel
- Outreach summary

⚙️ Platform Settings

- Toggles: email verify, Cashfree, mail poller
- Numbers: poller interval, resume size, offer validity
- Fees: currency, placement multiplier, access fees
- Env overrides: SMTP, IMAP, S3, WhatsApp, Cashfree, OpenAI → saved to DB
- Maintenance mode · Audit log (entity + action filters, CSV export)

💰 Payments & Placement Fees (merged page)

- Service Invoices tab: all company invoices with status filter
- Placement Fees tab: all PFIs with pending / collected totals
- Header KPIs: Total Invoiced · Collected · Outstanding · Overdue · Placement Fees

🎓 Training Manager (6 tabs)

- Training Catalogue — card view · add / edit topics with pricing
- Company Requests — approve (raise invoice) / reject with reason
- Internal Courses — post-hire video / quiz modules for hired employees
- Benchmarks — role skill benchmarks for course auto-assignment
- Assignments — all training assignments with progress bars
- Progress — per-employee training completion overview

7. HR Executive Portal

HR Operations

- Employee directory (create / update / deactivate)
- Department + role assignment, attendance tracking
- Task management (priority, status, notes, time logging)
- Dashboard KPIs (employees, leads, calls, tasks)
- Reports: HR summary, call volume, lead conversion, productivity

Recruitment Actions

- Bulk Resume Sourcing → upload PDFs per job → auto-create candidates
- Review / Approve / Reject interview requests from companies
- Scheduled Interviews view with real candidate contact info
- Confirm slot on behalf of sourced candidates (never logged in)
- Review + approve offer letter release requests

Invoices & Outreach

- Raise invoices for assigned companies · mark paid / partial
- Leads Pipeline: manage stage, assign, log calls
- Outreach replies inbox (email + WhatsApp unified)
- Reply to contacts, convert to leads, reassign
- Email + WhatsApp campaign management

8. Candidate & Company Portals

Candidate Portal

- Profile: headline, summary, experience, education, skills
- Upload resume → offline AI parse → skill vectors built
- Browse AI-ranked job listings (fit score per job)
- Self-apply with cover letter · track application status
- Confirm / reschedule interview slots
- Accept or decline offer letter
- Accept triggers hired_employees + training assignments
- Documents: upload certificates, ID etc.

Company Portal

- Post / edit / close job postings
- Browse Talent Pool (PII masked per grant)
- Shortlist applications · move status
- Request interview schedule (executive must approve)
- Record interview outcome · request offer release
- Send offer letter after exec approval + payment
- View & pay all invoices (placement + training fees)
- Request training for team → admin approves → pay invoice
- Company profile + approval status

Notifications (All Roles)

- lead_assigned · task_assigned · task_completed
- offer_request · offer_approved · offer_rejected
- reply_assigned · outreach_reply · whatsapp_reply
- lead_converted · campaign_sent · callback_scheduled
- training_request · training_approved · training_rejected
- bulk_resume_done · outreach_unmatched

Tech Stack

- Backend: Node.js + Express + mysql2/promise (port 5001)
- Frontend: React 19 + Vite + Tailwind CSS (port 5173)
- Auth: JWT in httpOnly cookie · bcrypt passwords
- Files: local disk (resumes) + AWS S3 (outreach lists)
- Email: GoDaddy SMTP (transactional + outreach)
- Payments: Cashfree (sandbox + prod modes)
- AI: Offline skill parser (no API key needed)